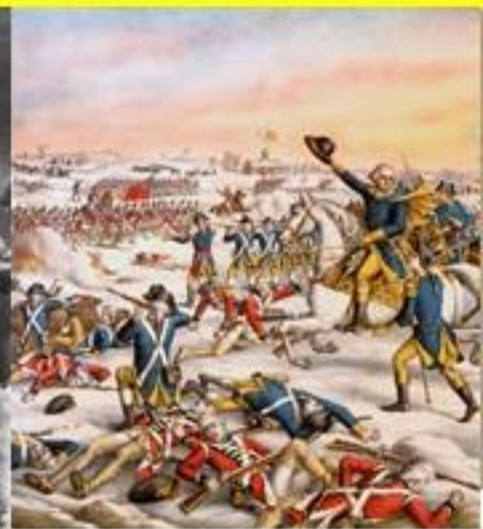


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE - 23

UNIFICATION OF ITALY-2

1 ROLE OF FRANCE

- 1 In 1830 a revolution started in France.
- 2 It was against the ideals of balance of power and **the legitimacy of the old order** proposed by the congress of Vienna.
- 3 Very soon the revolution spread to the various countries.
- 4 Inspired by this revolution people in various European countries demanded liberal constitution, democracy and downfall of absolute monarchy.



2 GIUSEPPE MAZZINI

- 1 Various states in Italy also got affected by the ideals of the revolution.
- 2 The first important attempt for the unification of Italy took place during this time.
- 3 Giuseppe Mazzini envisaged a coherent program for a unitary Italian republic.
- 4 He formed a secret society called young Italy for achieving the goal of unification.



Giuseppe Mazzini

3 REVOLUTION IN FRANCE IN 1848-49

- 1 A revolution on similar demands took place in France in 1848-49.
- 2 Soon like its predecessors it took various other European countries in its grip.
- 3 Inspired by the revolution, in 1849, Mazzini helped set up a revolutionary republic in Rome, but French forces soon crushed it with iron hands.



4 UNIFICATION OF ITALY- SARDINIA-PIEDMONT

1 The failure of revolutionary uprisings both in 1831 and 1848 meant that the mantle now fell on Sardinia-Piedmont under its ruler king Victor Emmanuel II to unify the Italian states through war.

2 In the eyes of the ruling elite of this region, a unified Italy offered them the possibility of economic development and political dominance.



king Victor Emmanuel II

4 UNIFICATION OF ITALY- SARDINIA-PIEDMONT

3 There were two reasons for which the unification of Italy under the aegis of Sardinia-piedmont was perceived to be best option.

i ✓ **Firstly**, Sardinia-piedmont was the only Italian state which was ruled by Italian monarchs, the rest of the other states were under the dominance of foreign rulers who were hostile to the demand of the unification.

✓ The ruler of the state Victor Emmanuel II was a liberal monarch who came up with a constitution and envisioned unification of rest other states on the similar constitutional arrangements.

ii ✓ **Secondly**, Sardinia-piedmont was one of the richest and technologically most advanced states of that time.



5 STATUTO

1 In the revolutionary year of 1848, the Piedmontese king Charles Albert issued a statuto, or constitution, converting his state to a constitutional monarchy.

2 The statuto of 1848, which borrowed heavily from English, American and Belgian models, established a parliamentary governments based on a limited franchise and guaranteeing civil rights.

3 Victor Emmanuel II, who succeeded his father in 1849, continued to recognise the statuto.

4 The erection of such a modern state focused the various liberal and national hopes in Italy on one state: Piedmont.



Charles Albert

1 VICTOR EMMANUEL II

1 After 1848, leadership of Risorgimento or Italian nationalist movement, passed to the kingdom of Sardinia, which included Piedmont, Nice and Savoy as well as the island of Sardinia.

2 Its constitutional monarch, Victor Emmanuel II, hoped to join other states to his own, thereby increasing his power.



5 PROCESS OF UNIFICATION OF ITALY FROM 1848-60

2 COUNT CAMILLO CAVOUR

- 1 In 1852, Victor Emmanuel made Count Camillo Cavour his prime minister.
- 2 Cavour came from a noble family but favoured liberal goals.
- 3 Once in office, Cavour moved first to reform Sardinia's economy.
- 4 He improved agriculture, had railroads built, and encouraged commerce by supporting free trade.
- 5 Cavour's long term goal, however was to end Austrian power in Italy and annex the provinces of Lombardy and Venetia.



COUNT CAMILLO CAVOUR

3 CAVOUR'S FOREIGN POLICY

- 1 Cavour did not hesitate to leverage on the international relations for achieving the unification of Italy.
- 2 He was eager to involve foreign powers for the cause of unification.
- 3 In foreign policy, Cavour, a realist was aware that the Italian unification could only become a reality if Italy could evict its foreign hegemony- the Austrian empire.
- 4 This, in turn, could only be achieved with foreign aid, namely that of France, which was newly interested (under Napoleon III) in undermining Austrian power.



3 CAVOUR'S FOREIGN POLICY

- 5 He meticulously made Sardinia involved in various regional and international affairs in order to win allies and achieve the goal of Italian unification.
- 6 In a nut shell he adhered to "Realpolitik" for the attainment of unification.
- 7 Thus led by Cavour in 1855, Sardinia joined Britain and France against Russia in the Crimean war.
- 8 Sardinia did not win territory, but it did have a voice at the peace conference. Sardinia also gained attention of Napoleon III, the ruler of France.



4 SECRET DEAL WITH FRANCE

- 1 In 1858, Cavour settled a secret deal with Napoleon III, who assured to assist Sardinia in case it faced a war with Austria.
- 2 A year later, the insightful Cavour provoked that the war with Austria.
- 3 With help from France, Sardinia defeated Austria and annexed Lombardy.
- 4 It was the first concrete step which further galvanised the unification.



5 PLEBISCITE

- 1 In the same year in plebiscites, the northern and central states voted overwhelmingly to join Piedmont.
- 2 In Treaty of Turin (1860) Napoleon recognised Piedmont's annexation of Tuscany, Modena, Parma and Bologna.



6 FIRST PARLIAMENT

- 1 In 1860, representatives from all the northern states apart from Venetia (which was still under the control of Austria) gathered at the Piedmontese capital of Turin and attended the first parliament of the enlarged kingdom.



1 STATUS OF STATES

- 1 In 1860 a northern Italian kingdom, under the leadership of Victor Emmanuel II, existed alongside the papal states in the middle of the peninsula and the kingdom of the two Sicilies in the south.
- 2 The Papal states were ruled over by the Pope while the two Sicilies were under the control of Bourbon ruler.
- 3 The only northern state that remained out of the control of Sardinia in 1860 was Venetia, which was under the direct control of Austria.





2

ANNEXATION OF TWO SICILIES

- 1 After annexation of the grand duchy of Tuscany, the duchies of Modena and Parma and the Romagna to Piedmont in March 1860, Italian nationalists set their sights on the kingdom of the Two Sicilies, which comprised all of southern mainland Italy, and Sicily, as the next step toward their dream of unification of all Italian lands.
- 2 In order to liberate the Two Sicilies from the Bourbon ruler, Cavour architected an expedition under Garibaldi.
- 3 The expedition was an ambitious and risky venture aiming to conquer, with a thousand men, a kingdom with a larger regular army and a very powerful navy.
- 4 The expedition of the Thousand led by Garibaldi landed in Sicily in order to conquer the kingdom of the Two Sicilies, ruled by the Bourbons.



2 ANNEXATION OF TWO SICILIES

5 Army of a thousand red shirts under the leadership of Garibaldi landed at Marsala in Sicily on May 11, 1860.

6 The political ambiance was already surcharged against the foreign rule and corruption in the government in the two Sicilies.

7 Enjoying the popular support of people, Garibaldi captured Palermo, the capital of Sicily by the end of May.

8 In late August he crossed over to the mainland. Naples, the mainland capital, fell on September 7, 1860.

9 Thousands had deserted from the royal Sicilian army to join Garibaldi. Finally two Sicilies got annexed to Sardinia.



3 VENETIA AND PAPAL STATES

1 After winning the two sicilies, only two Italian states were outside the control of Sardinia. These were Venetia and papal state.

2 Venetia was under the direct control of Austria.

3 Papal state was controlled by the Pope. The Pope being the religious head of the catholic church enjoyed the support of conservatives in France and Austria.

4 Thus to attack the territories of the pope meant antagonizing France and Austria which Sardinia wanted to avoid.



4 CAVOUR'S DIPLOMACY

1 But after capturing Naples, Garibaldi decided to advance to Rome, instead of stopping in Naples. Cavour became increasingly worried because of this.

2 If Rome was attacked, France and Austria would immediately help the pope and crush the opposing army, thereby discrediting and destroying the agenda of unification of Italy.

3 In another sparkling move of diplomacy, Cavour encouraged riots and uprisings in the papal states thus giving the Piedmontese troops a reason to come under the pretext of maintaining order.

4 In 1860, two thirds of the papal states joined Piedmont and Rome left alone.



5 VICTOR EMMANUEL II - NEW KING OF ITALY

1 As the Piedmontese army bypassed Rome and remaining Papal states (which remained under the control of Rome) and marched south, Garibaldi gave up command of his army and shook hands with Victor Emanuel II.

2 As under Victor Emmanuel II it was not the democratic or the republican government that was to be formed but a constitutional monarchy.

3 As a result of this Victor Emmanuel II was proclaimed as the new king of Italy, with Florence as its capital.



Garibaldi

6 PROCESS OF UNIFICATION OF ITALY AFTER 1860

6 AUSTRO-PRUSSIAN WAR – ANNEXATION OF VENETIA

1 In 1866 Italy allied itself with Prussia, and when Prussia defeated Austria, Italy was rewarded with Venetia for staying out of the war.

2 Thus the kingdom of Italy added Venetia to its holdings in 1866 following the Austrian defeat in 1866 Austro-Prussian war.



6 PROCESS OF UNIFICATION OF ITALY AFTER 1860

7 FRANCO-PRUSSIAN WAR – ANNEXATION OF PAPAL STATES

- 1 After 1866, a part of the papal states remained outside the control of Italy.
- 2 French troops were the main barrier to Italian occupation of the papal states after 1867; however, when Prussia declared war upon France in the summer of 1870, the Italians took advantage of the situation.
- 3 With French resources allocated to the struggle of the Franco-Prussian war (1870-71), Napoleon III ordered his troops out of the Italian peninsula.

- 4 The Italians entered the papal states in September 1870 and, through the backing of a Plebiscite held in early October, annexed the papal states and Rome to the kingdom of Italy.
- 5 Unification of Italy got completed with this.



YEAR	STATE/TERRITORY	IMPORTANT EVENTS
1848	Piedmont-Sardinia	King Charles albert converted his state to a constitutional monarchy
1852	Piedmont-Sardinia	Cavour made prime minister who starts leveraging on foreign policy for unification
1855	Piedmont-Sardinia	Participation in Crimean war with Britain and France to gain their favours
1859-60	Lombardy unified with piedmont-Sardinia	A secret alliance with napoleon III of France against Austria, defeat of Austria by piedmont- Sardinia
1860	Parma, Modena, Tuscany unified with piedmont-Sardinia	Plebiscites in the northern and central states where people voted overwhelmingly to join piedmont.

YEAR	STATE/TERRITORY	IMPORTANT EVENTS
1860	Sicily and Naples	Action by thousand red shirts volunteers under Garibaldi helped to unify Sicily and Naples with piedmont-Sardinia.
1860	Parts of papal states	Riots and uprisings in papal states against the rule of pope and two thirds of the papal states joined piedmont
1866	Venetia	In Austro-Prussian war, Italy sided with Prussia and was rewarded with Venetia after the defeat of Austria
1870	Rome	During Franco-Prussian war(1870-71) French soldiers vacated Rome, Sardinian army entered the papal states through the backing of a plebiscite Rome was unified.

QUESTIONS FOR PRACTICE

1. "Italy is merely a geographical expression". Do you agree with these words of Metternich?

150 words

2. "Cavour was the most important and the most successful of the exponents of Italian Unification". How far do you agree with this assertion?

250 words

3. How does Nationalism unify the people of the Italian states?

150 words

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